



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

We are all familiar with the idea that some facts about ourselves are determined by factors outside of our control. Obvious examples include things like hair color and height, which are determined by our genetic inheritance. But we often also explain personality traits, and likes and dislikes, in terms of both our genetic inheritance and the way in which we were raised. Others might be explained in terms of various features of our environment.

So we can raise this question:

Suppose that **everything** about me — my likes and dislikes, my choices and decisions — is ultimately determined by factors outside of my control. Is that compatible with me having free will?

If we are not assuming that determinism is true, then why are we talking about it? The answer is that it is a good way to raise a question about the conditions under which free will is possible.

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We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.



0. There is no fire in.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one



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A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

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3. If determined, the only one



nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

1. No one has any choice about events which

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

happened in the distant past.

then DECISION. (4,5)



4. If determinism is true, the laws of

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

varlatatie + the last of the

then DECISION happens. (3)

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

future is not as it was with the state of the

of interest.

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

about whether @.

C. If determinis_true , then no_one_has_any

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

and none has any choice about whether,

theorie about the fact that if DNR

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

rules out free will.

choice principle, and determinism

Since the first three of these theses

seem quite plausible, the argument

hence that free will is incompatible with

true, there are no free actions — and

seems to show that if determinism is







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Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

against
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A red circular button with a slight drop shadow, containing the text "against incompatibilist free will" in white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

against
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The best way to bring out this challenge is to pose a question about the

conditions under which free will is possible.

Our problem today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.



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